What the checkout shows, and what I changed

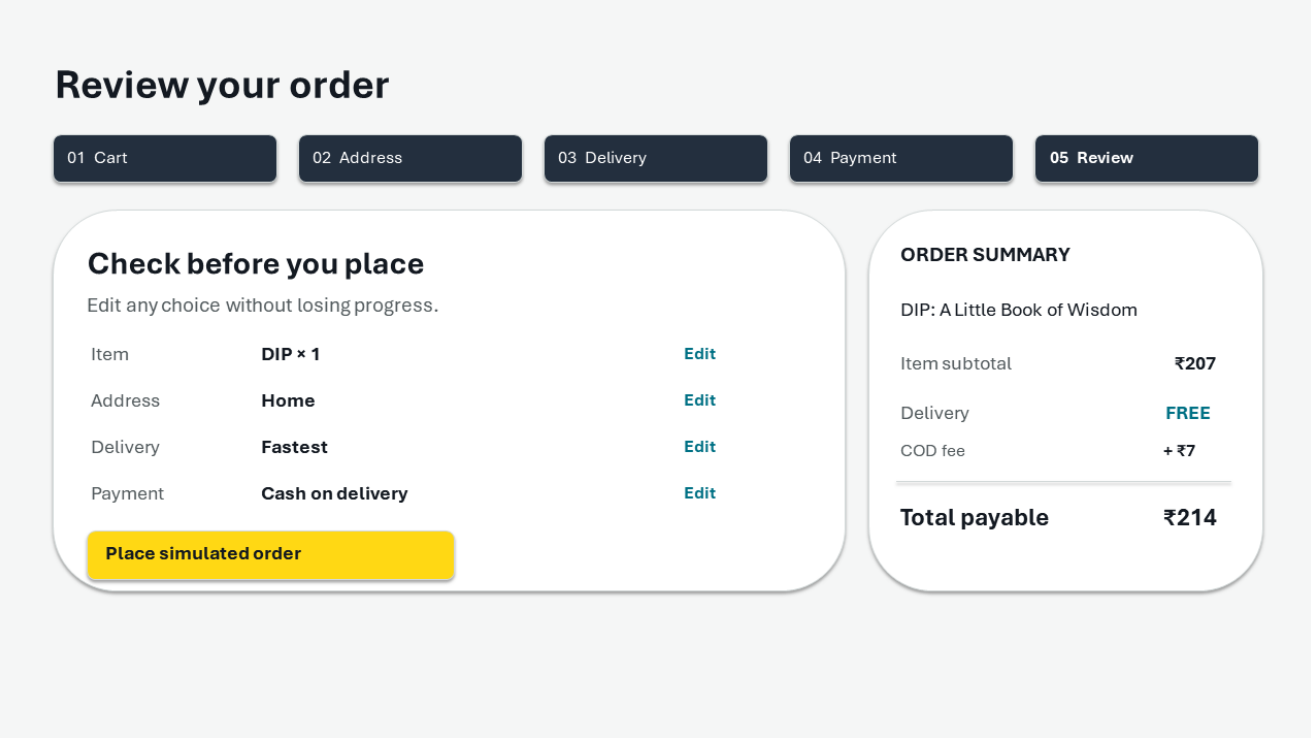
A single desktop journey, six heuristic questions, and nine proposed screens

REAL INTERFACE

Seven public screenshot crops from one checkout and cancellation

REDESIGN

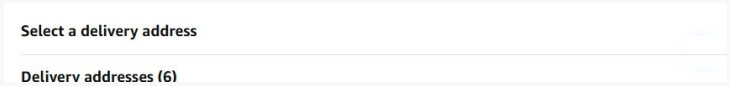
Editable screen designs and a working checkout simulation

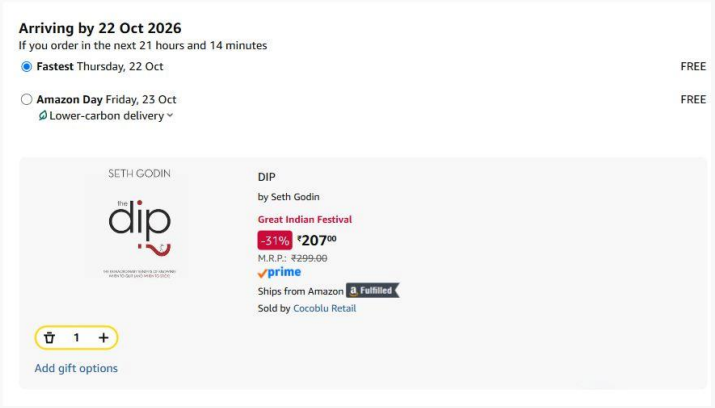


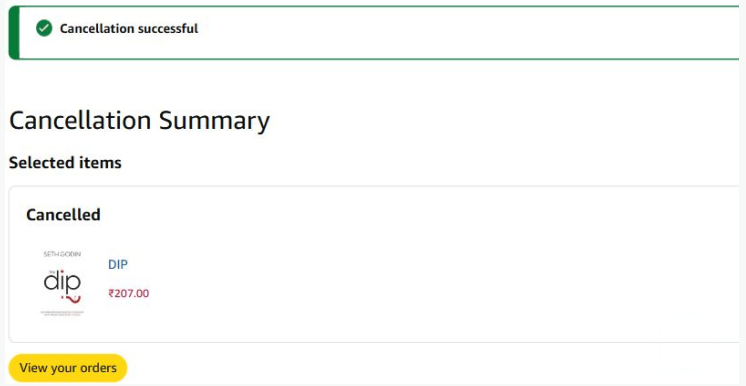
Proposed review screen. This is a concept, not an Amazon screen.

Evidence: one observed journey

Seven original crops. One cash-on-delivery order placed and cancelled immediately.







EV-02 · ADDRESS

Address choices are indicated; personal rows are withheld.

EV-04 · DELIVERY

Two delivery choices appear, both marked free.

EV-07 · CANCELLATION

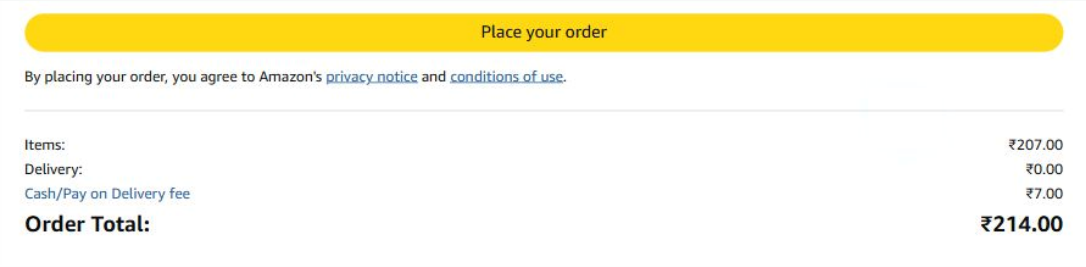
Cancellation completed after the observed order.

Evidence boundary: no participants, analytics baseline, or real payment failure were observed.

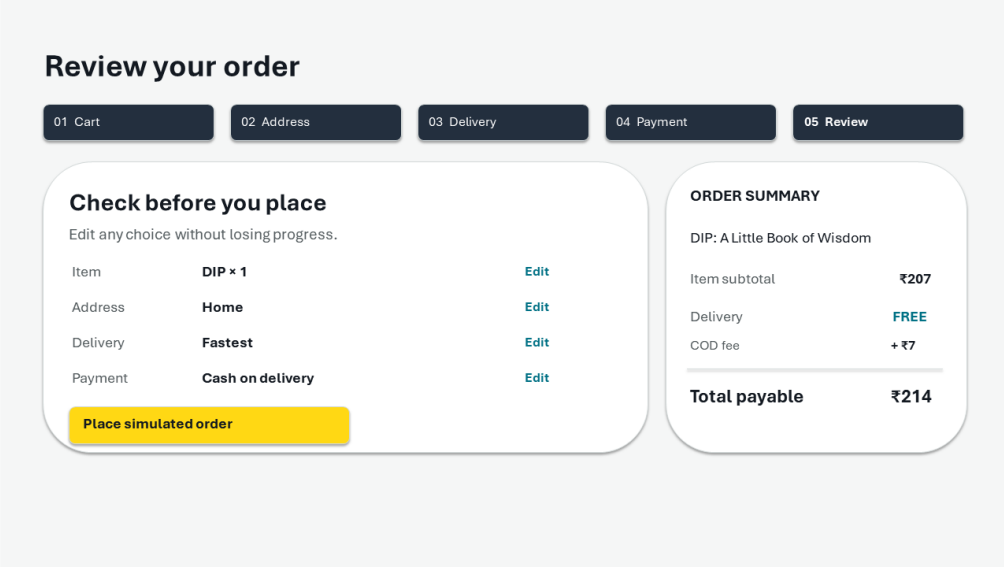
01 Final cost may be easy to miss

Nielsen #1: visibility of system status · Current fact versus design response

OBSERVED ON AMAZON · EV-05



PROPOSED REVIEW



₹207 item + ₹7 COD fee = ₹214 total

The final amount is visible at review. Whether shoppers notice the fee before commitment is unmeasured.

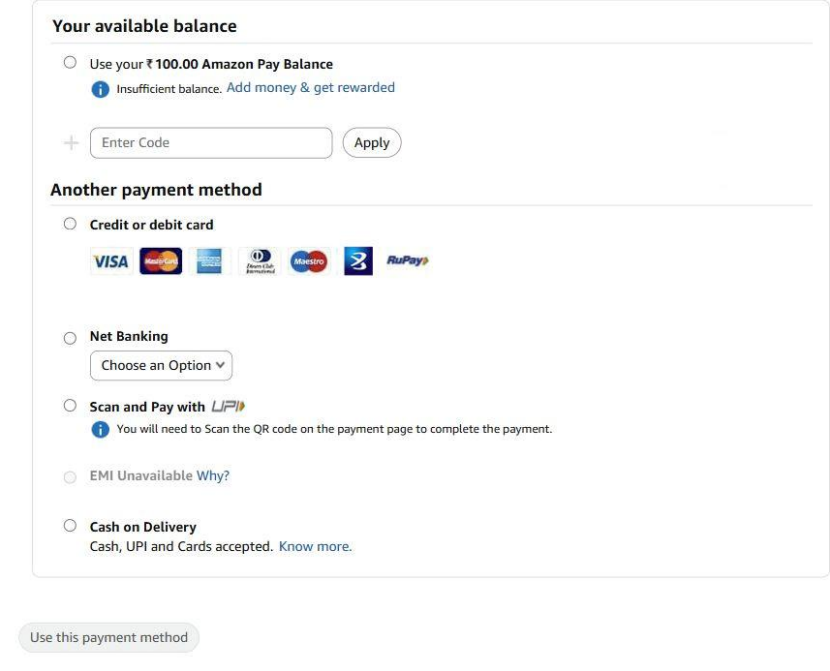
Itemized summary beside the decision; explicit total payable and Edit actions.

Test: ask shoppers to state the total and the reason for the extra ₹7 before clicking.

02 Payment methods need cost context

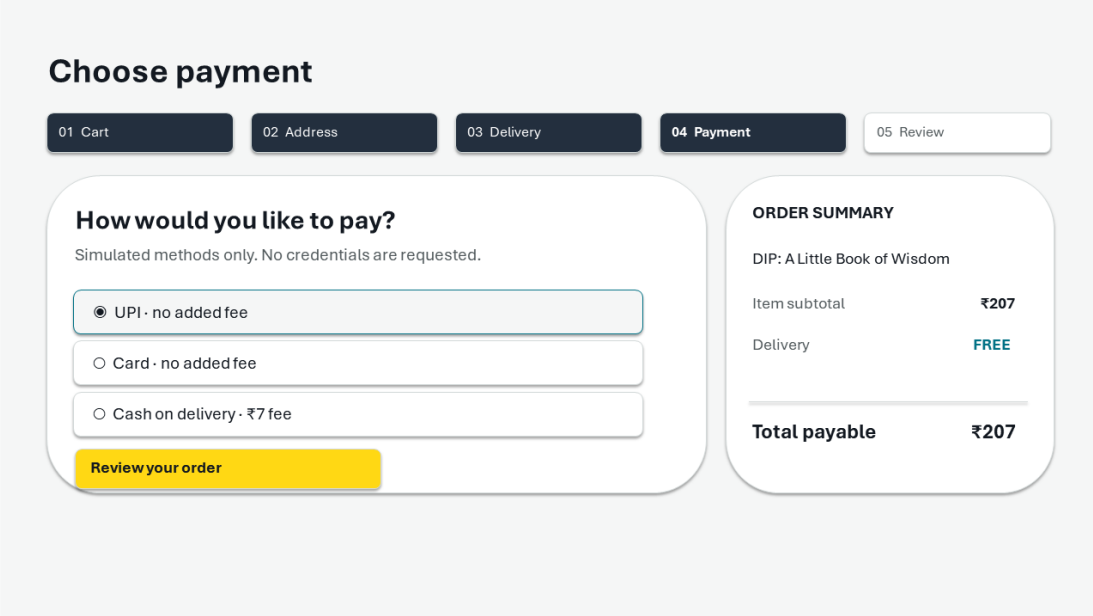
Nielsen #2: match to familiar language · Hick's Law: decision effort

OBSERVED ON AMAZON · EV-03



Visible fact: multiple payment labels and an insufficient balance message.

PROPOSED PAYMENT DESIGN



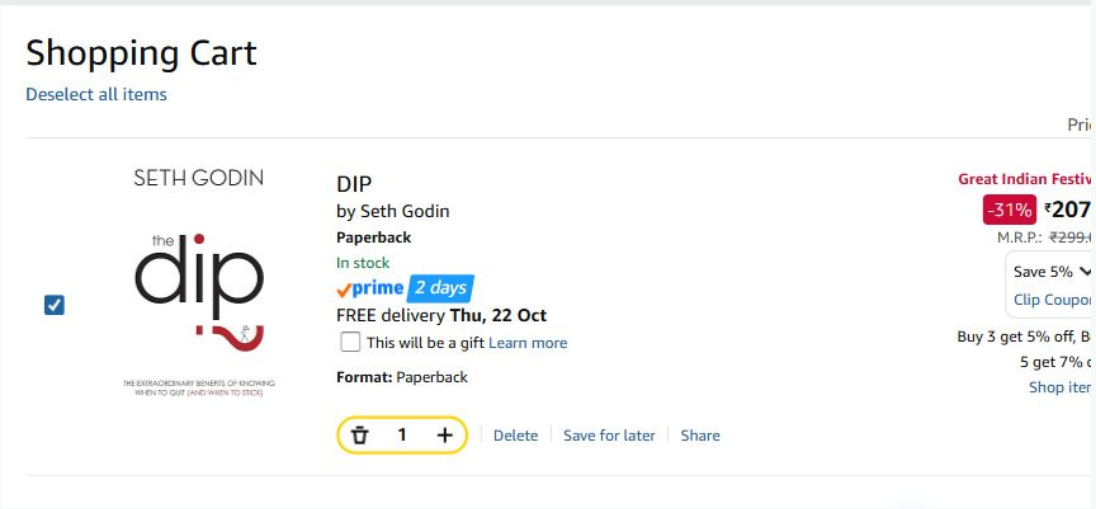
Change: group methods, use plain labels, and show the COD fee at selection.

Test: compare method comprehension and selection time; a current violation is unproven.

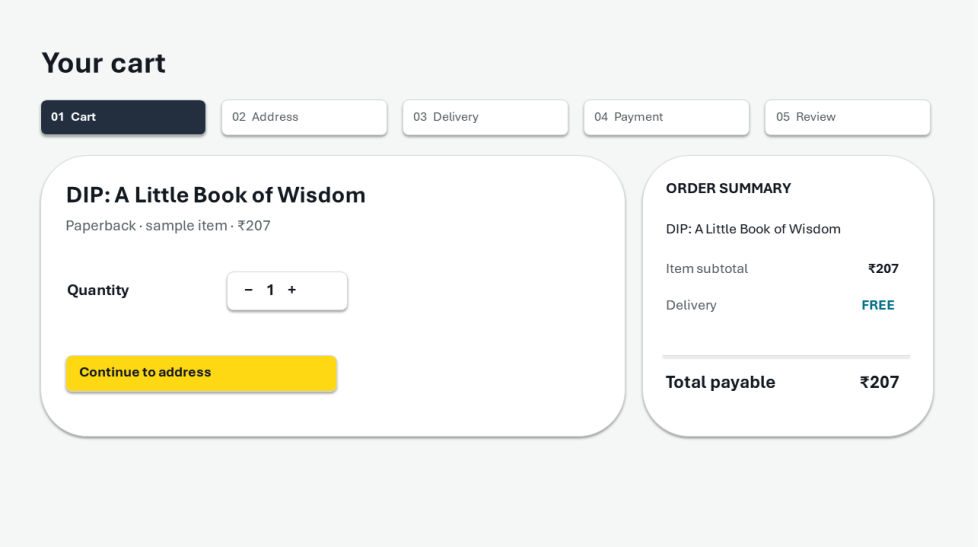
03 Choices and controls compete for attention

Nielsen #8 and #7 · Hick's Law and Fitts's Law

OBSERVED CART · EV-01



PROPOSED CART



Hypothesis: competing decisions

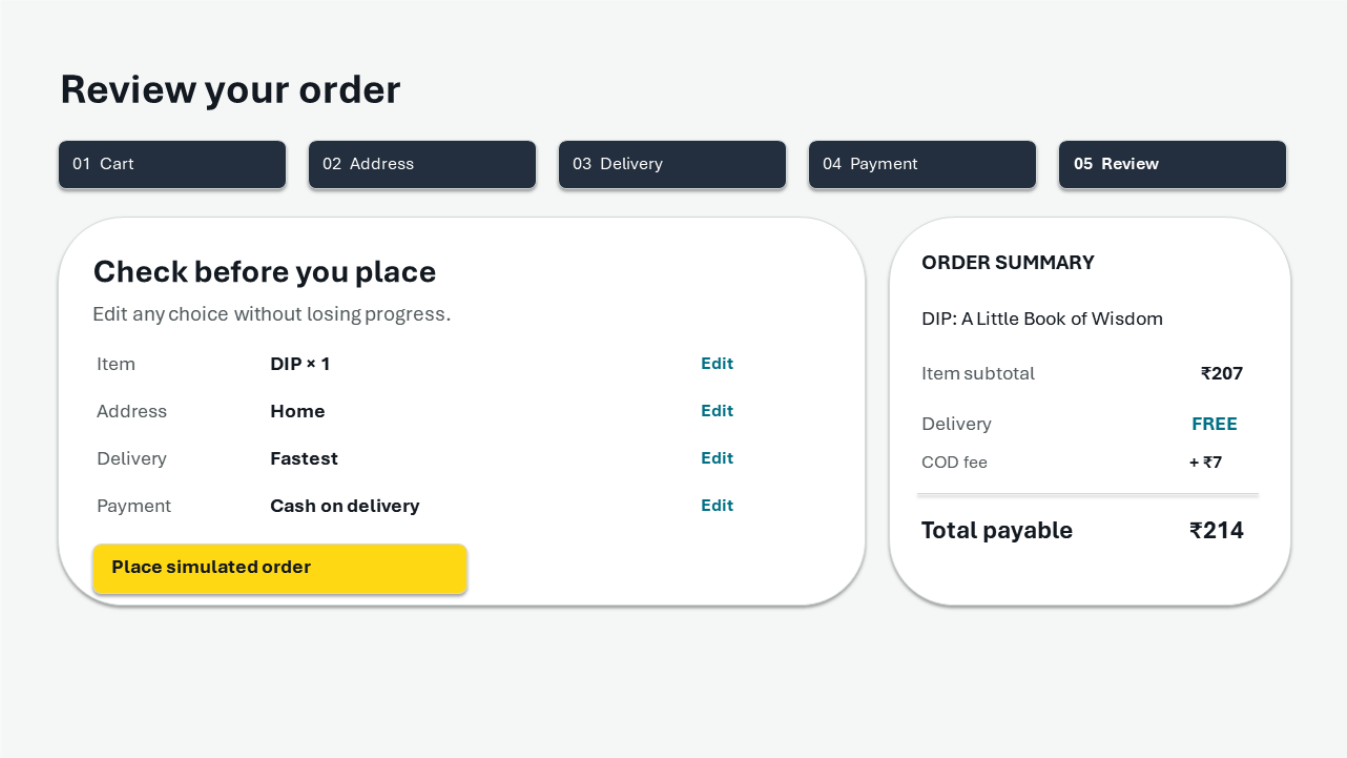
Promotion content and quantity control share the cart view. Decision effort has not been timed.

Change: clearer action hierarchy

Keep quantity and continue actions prominent, with larger consistent click areas.

04 Editing should preserve the journey

Nielsen #3 and #7 · Jakob's Law: familiar editing · Fitts's Law: target size



WHAT WAS OBSERVED

The review flow offered Change links. The public crop does not show those controls or prove rework.

WHAT I CHANGED

Each decision has a direct Edit action. The interactive prototype keeps previous selections after editing.

Test: change address and payment from review; record wrong turns and retained state.

05 Failure recovery is a design scenario

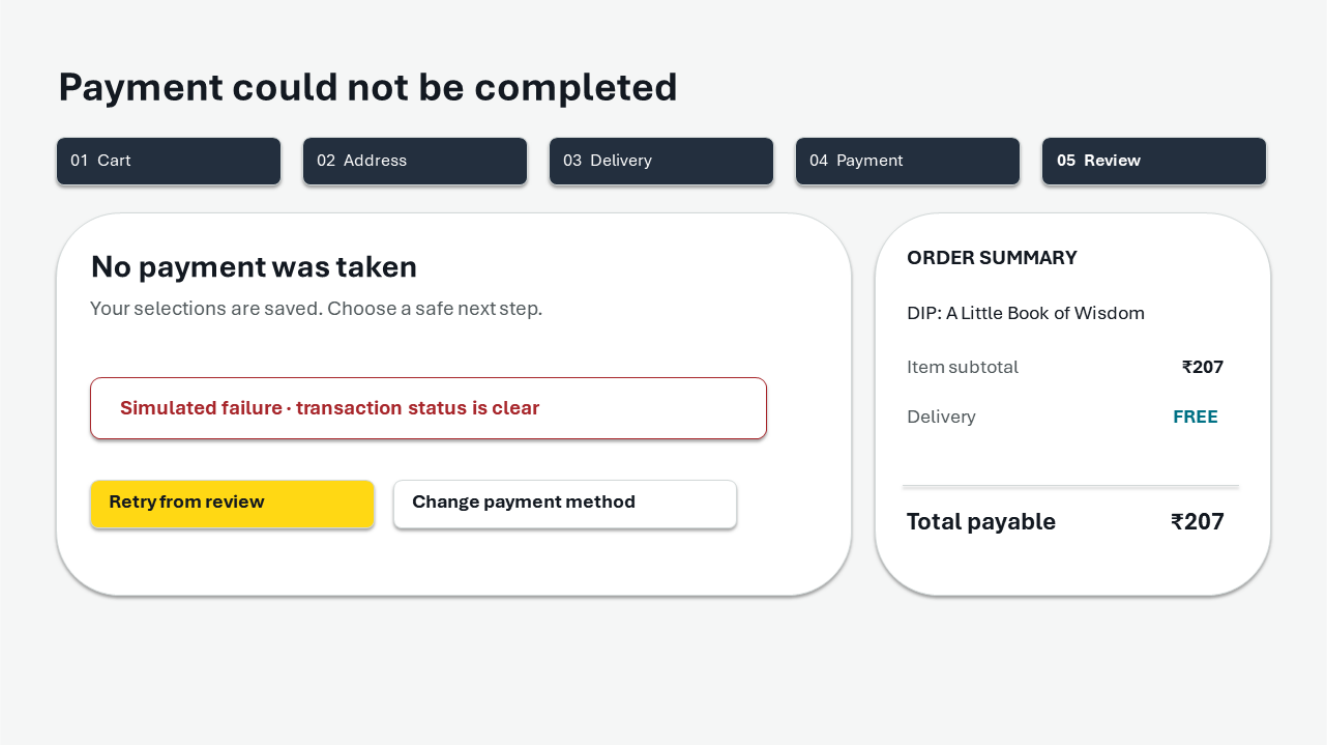
Nielsen #9: help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors

OBSERVED OUTCOME · EV-06



The observed order succeeded. No failure screen was captured.

PROPOSED FAILURE STATE



The concept makes transaction status explicit and offers safe recovery.

Heuristic map: observation, risk, response

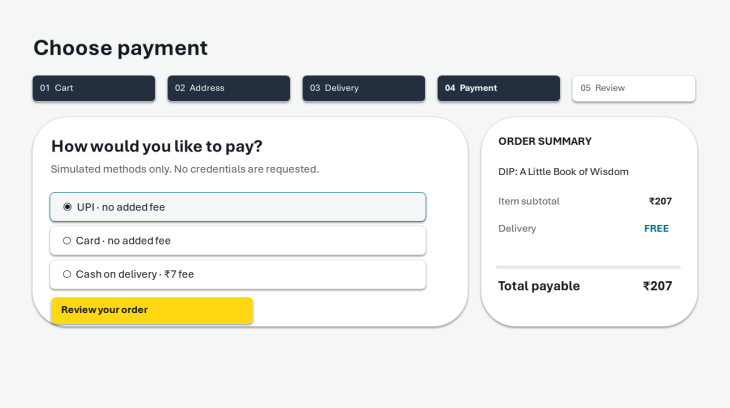
A heuristic concern is an expert assessment. A user impact requires a user study.

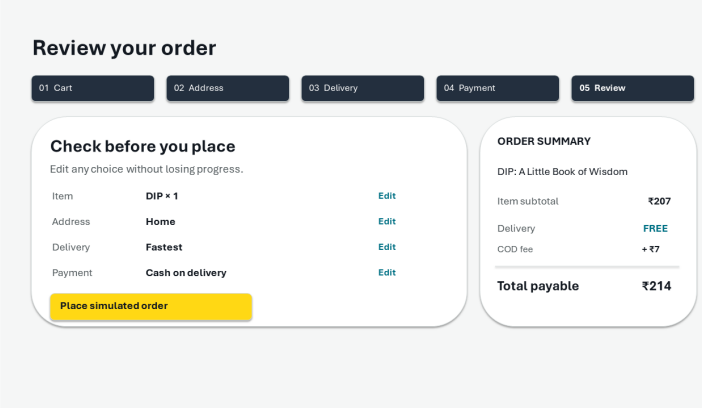
Heuristic	Observed	Risk or limit	Proposed change
#1 Visibility	₹7 COD fee and ₹214 total visible	Fee comprehension unknown	Persistent itemized total
#2 Real-world match	Several payment labels shown	Meaning or fee may need context	Plain labels and fee at choice
#3 User control	Change links observed at review	Rework not established	Direct Edit, retained choices
#7 Efficiency	Quantity and Change controls visible	Pointer misses unmeasured	Consistent click targets
#8 Minimalism	Promotions and choices share view	Decision effort unmeasured	Clearer hierarchy
#9 Error recovery	No failure captured	Scenario only	Explicit status and safe retry

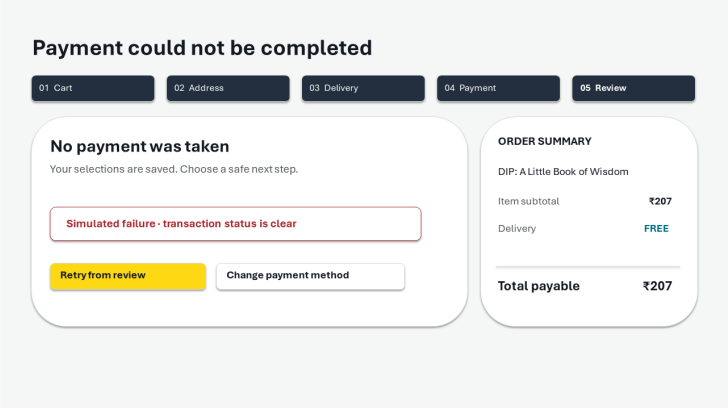
No measured conversion, error, time, or satisfaction baseline is available.

The new design makes decisions more explicit

Nine editable screens in Penpot and PowerPoint. A separate React prototype demonstrates the flow.







Payment

Fee shown with the method

Review

Total and edits together

Failure

Status plus recovery

Prototype: kunalmahurkar.is-a.dev/amazon-checkout-prototype/

Next step: test the proposed improvements

Priority reflects expert judgement. No usability sessions or outcome metrics have been measured.

P1 · Total and fee

Ask shoppers to state the amount payable and explain the COD fee before placing an order.

P1 discovery · Failure recovery

Use a controlled simulated failure. Check whether shoppers understand payment status and recover safely.

P2 · Payment and editing

Compare method comprehension and late-edit success without prompting.

P3 · Pointer targets

Measure target sizes and missed clicks during desktop tasks.

Measures: correct total and fee, unaided task success, time, errors, recovery success, confidence.

References: nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/ · interaction-design.org/literature/topics/hick-s-law · interaction-design.org/literature/topics/fitts-law